Executive Summary

Consumer Complaint Monitoring and Response Dashboard

Project Overview

This project analyzed 62,516 Bank of America consumer complaint records collected through the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB), covering the period from 1 May 2017 to 28 August 2023.

The objective was to develop an interactive Power BI dashboard that provides visibility into complaint volumes, financial products, recurring consumer issues, company response classifications, response timeliness, and CFPB complaint-forwarding intervals.

Key Findings

The analysis identified five important observations:

1. **Response timeliness:** 96.96% of eligible complaints were classified as receiving timely responses. This calculation excluded 1,494 complaints, still recorded as in progress.
2. **Response outcomes:** Closed with explanation was the largest recorded outcome, representing 41,044 complaints, approximately 65.65% of the dataset.
3. **Recorded consumer relief:** A combined 19,970 complaints were classified as receiving monetary or non-monetary relief, representing approximately 31.94% of all complaints.
4. **CFPB forwarding performance:** Approximately 79.40% of complaints were forwarded to the company on the same day they were received by the CFPB. The average forwarding interval was approximately 1.22 days.
5. **Long forwarding intervals:** A smaller group of complaints experienced forwarding intervals exceeding 30 days, including 48 complaints exceeding 90 days. The longest observed interval was 275 days.

Business Recommendations

Based on the findings, the following actions are recommended:

- Investigate complaints with unusually long CFPB forwarding intervals to identify possible operational bottlenecks or exceptional cases.
- Monitor high-volume financial products and recurring complaint issues to identify areas requiring further investigation.
- Strengthen management monitoring of response outcomes, relief classifications, and complaints remaining in progress.

Methodology and Tools

The project involved data inspection, cleaning, transformation, validation, database development, SQL analysis, KPI development, and interactive dashboard creation.

The tools used included:

- Microsoft Excel for initial data inspection, cleaning, and validation.
- MySQL Workbench 8.0 for relational database storage, SQL queries, and data validation.
- Microsoft Power BI Desktop for data modelling, DAX calculations, interactive visualizations, and dashboard development.

Limitations

The analysis is based on recorded CFPB complaint information and should not be interpreted as proof of misconduct, regulatory violations, or customer dissatisfaction.

The timely response rate excludes complaints still in progress. CFPB forwarding intervals measure the time between CFPB receipt and forwarding to the company, not the company's response or resolution time. Complaint counts also do not represent complaint rates among all customers because total customer or account exposure figures were not available.

Conclusion

The completed dashboard provides a structured view of Bank of America's consumer complaint patterns and recorded response outcomes over the study period. It supports evidence-based monitoring, highlights areas requiring further investigation, and provides management with a foundation for more informed operational decision-making.